

PARENT TIPS

Finding out your teen is pregnant

It can be a shock to learn that your teen or your teen's partner is pregnant. There are support groups that can help you to support them, whatever they decide to do.

- Calm, nonjudgmental support will be what your teen needs most.
- You can help them to find out all the information they'll need in order to decide what they want to do next.
- Even if you have strong views about what decision they should make, listen to them, as well as offering advice and guidance.

**◀ Providing support**

This is a time when your teen needs to hear that you love and care about them.

TEEN HINTS

Telling your parents or partner

Health clinics and doctors can offer confidential advice. However, if you're pregnant (or think you are), talking to someone you trust can provide the support you need. It can be a daunting prospect, so plan when and how to talk to them.

- Telling them the news when you are doing something together, such as helping with chores, can make the conversation feel less intense.
- Keep the conversation private, unless you think it will be better to tell them in public if you are concerned about how they will react.
- Be calm and explain the situation fully; if you don't panic, they are less likely to.
- Respect their advice, but remember you make the final decision.

▷ Food cravings

Some people get strange cravings or aversions to certain foods, or notice strange smells and tastes.

**▽ Needing the bathroom**

As pregnancy continues, there's a noticeable increase in the number of times a person needs to urinate throughout the day.

**△ Increased breast size**

Breasts might grow and become tender to touch.

**Taking a pregnancy test**

Most pregnancy tests can be taken from the first day of a missed period or 21 days after an unprotected sexual encounter, although some work even sooner. Tests can be purchased in pharmacies, although some clinics will test for free. If the result is positive, a doctor's advice should be sought as soon as possible. A negative test might be false, so take a second test a few days later if the period still hasn't started.

**◀ Testing at home**

Read the packaging of each pregnancy test to ensure it is used properly.